

Question 36 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Analyse how an HRD system can become ineffective when its practices are designed without organisational strategy alignment.

Introduction

Ineffectiveness here means the HRD system may look active — forms, courses, speeches — yet people do not gain the capabilities the organisation needs, and business results and future readiness do not improve. Analysis traces how missing alignment produces wrong content, broken promises, cynicism and finally strategic failure.

Detailed points

- 1. Wrong competencies are developed.** Staff become very good at yesterday's work while strategy needs new capabilities (digital, new market, new quality). Effort is large; direction is wrong. This is ineffectiveness despite hard work.
- 2. Budget is spent on the periphery.** Popular programmes flourish; critical roles for the strategy stay weak. Opportunity cost is the centre of the analysis. A full training calendar can hide empty strategy support.
- 3. Career paths become promises to nowhere.** Plans that do not match the future structure (for example, many managerial rungs while the firm is flattening) create anger when jobs never appear. Climate and trust fall, which further reduces HRD effectiveness.
- 4. Appraisal chases old measures.** People 'perform' on a scorecard that strategy has already abandoned (volume without quality, for example). HRD then reinforces the wrong behaviour. The system is worse than inactive — it is actively misaligned.
- 5. Top management withdraws support.** Business heads see no return and cut HRD. The system shrinks. Remaining practices become even more ritual. Ineffectiveness becomes structural.
- 6. Talent leaves; who stays may be less capable.** High performers go to firms where growth matches business. HRD then works with a weaker audience. Capability gap versus strategy widens.
- 7. Strategy implementation itself fails.** The organisation cannot execute its own plan. HRD ineffectiveness becomes organisational ineffectiveness — quality failure, digital lag, failed expansion. Analysis must connect the two.
- 8. Illusion of success delays correction.** High training days and completed appraisals look good in reports until a crisis. Activity metrics hide irrelevance. An unaligned system can therefore remain 'successful' on paper while being ineffective in reality for a long time.

Conclusion. Without strategy alignment, HRD develops the wrong things, wastes money, breaks career trust, teaches old behaviours, loses support and talent, and finally fails the business. Alignment is a condition of effectiveness, not a decoration on an HRD brochure.